

FLEET RULE OF THE ROAD TEST NOV 15

This test is based on: The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea (1972) with amendments in force up to December 2009 as detailed in "A Seaman's Guide Pocket Book of The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea" (BR 453 Supp), ATP1(F) Vol I and the Mariners Handbook (NP100).

The test is designed to be given to any Warfare Officer, Deck officer, Officer undertaking bridge watch-keeping duties or Young Officer/Cadet. The test should be administered under written exam conditions, the results should be recorded in the OOW training records for inspection by FLEET/FOST navigation staff. The exam should take no longer than 1 hr.

In this test, any change in the status of the ship or of the environment will be indicated in the script. Rules 1 to 19, 34, 35 and Annex IV must be known instinctively for instant application. A thorough knowledge of the other rules is required. The pass mark is 90%.

Answers are provided for uniformity of marking. This test follows the same format as the Ship Command Rule of the Road paper.

You are the NO in HMS DEFENDER (Length 152.4m) alongside in San Diego, USA. You are due to sail tomorrow to act as Plane Guard during a short air defence exercise and are conducting a session of OOW shareholders prior to sailing.

1. The embarked US Officer has some local knowledge to impart, and informs the team that the direction of buoyage is reversed in US relation to the UK. What is the name of this buoyage system, and which region is the US? **(1)**

2. Does this alter any obligations under the narrow channel rule? (R. 9) **(1)**

3. There are several local rules outlined for San Diego. What do the rules state about the operation of special rules? (R. 1b) **(2)**

4. One local rule specific to inland waters of the US is that a vessel must sound one prolonged blast when getting underway. When un-berthing tomorrow, specifically at what point will you be underway? (R. 3i) **(2)**

After shareholders, you brief the CO on the departure. While examining the charts, he has several questions.

5. How should a vessel navigate down the course of a narrow channel or fairway? (R. 9a) **(1)**

6. What vessels shall not impede the passage of a vessel which can safely navigate only within a narrow channel or fairway? (R. 9b) **(2)**

7. There are several bends along the navigation track. What actions should you take when nearing a bend or an area of a narrow channel or fairway where other vessels may be obscured by an intervening obstruction? (R. 9f) **(1)**

The CO approves the departure plan. You are up on the bridge early the next morning to make final preparations for sailing.

8. You sight a vessel in the early morning twilight proceeding outbound in the main channel showing white over red masthead lights in addition to sidelights and sternlight. What can you deduce about this vessel? (R. 29a) **(2)**

9. What additional identifying sound signal would this vessel make in restricted visibility? (R. 35k) **(2)**

The ship closes up SSD and after sailing from alongside the CO hands you the ship and you commence the outbound pilotage.

10. On taking the ship you sight a small power-driven vessel at green 45 at 5 cables crossing the channel. Her bearing is steady and it soon becomes clear that she will impede your passage and involve risk of collision. What is your obligation, who is the give-way vessel, and what is the obligation of the other vessel given she had already impeded your passage? (R. 8f, 9b, 15,) **(5)**

The above situation is resolved and the pilotage continues.

11. The OOW reports an outbound merchant vessel closing slowly from red 170 at 2nm. What situation is this? (R. 13b) **(2)**

12. If you alter course 70° to port in accordance with your navigation track how would this change the situation? (R. 13d) **(2)**

13. Your CO keen to avoid being overtaken by a merchant vessel suggests an increase in speed to 20 knots. What do the rules state about every vessel proceeding at a safe speed and detail the factors which should be among those taken into account by all vessels? (R 6a, 6b) **(7)**

You clear Point Loma and fall out SSD. At red 20 at 5nm you sight two small power driven vessels. Their range is closing and with both vessels visual bearings drawing very slowly right.

14. As the range reduces to 3nm you sight two cones apexes together on both vessels. What do these shapes mean? (R. 26b) **(1)**

15. How is this vessel defined? (R. 3d) **(1)**

16. What lights would these vessels show by night? (R. 26b) **(3)**

17. What sound signals would this vessel make in restricted visibility? (R. 35c) **(2)**

18. In accordance with Rule 18 you make a bold alteration of course to starboard to keep clear of the fishing vessels. Should you use sound signals prior to this manoeuvre? Justify your answer. (R. 34a) **(2)**

You clear these vessels and proceed toward your ADEX RV. Unfortunately visibility begins to reduce to 1nm.

19. You detect by radar alone the presence of another vessel at red 20 range 5nm. What must you determine, and if action to avoid collision is required, what should be avoided? (R. 19d) **(4)**

20. You now hold a small power driven vessel visually at green 40 at 1nm and are 60° on her port bow with the bearing drawing very slowly left. Does Rule 19 apply to this situation and explain how you would manoeuvre for this contact. (R. 19a, 15) **(3)**

Visibility increases to excess of 5nm and you continue your transit to the RV.

21. You approach the formation and note that all other ships are in station. What is stated about how ships in and not in station should manoeuvre? (ATP1F) **(2)**

22. What is the order of priority applicable to Allied Naval ships? (ATP1F) **(6)**

23. Do the priorities above take precedence over the International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea between military vessels at sea? (ATP1F) **(1)**

The exercise completes at sunset. As you break away you note that the USS Carrier does not have navigation lights in standard positions.

24. What do the Rules say about the operation of special rules with respect to additional station or signal lights? (R. 1c) **(2)**

You are preparing night orders after a long day on the bridge when the USS Carrier sends Flag 5 with a time and you hear her sounding 6 short blasts.

25. What does this mean? (ATP 1F) **(1)**

You report this to the CO and head down below for dinner.

Total _____ / 58

ANSWERS

You are the NO in HMS DEFENDER (Length 152.4m) alongside in San Diego, USA. You are due to sail tomorrow to act as Plane Guard during a short air defence exercise and are conducting a session of OOW shareholders prior to sailing.

1. The embarked US Officer has some local knowledge to impart, and informs the team that the direction of buoyage is reversed in relation to the UK. What system is this known as and what Region is the US? (1)

IALA Maritime Bouyage System & Region B. (1)

(International Association of Marine Aids to Navigation and Light House Authority)

2. Does this alter any obligations under the narrow channel rule? (R. 9) (1)

No

3. There are several local rules outlined for San Diego. What do the rules state about the operation of special rules? (R. 1b) (2)

Nothing in these Rules shall interfere with the operation of special rules made by an appropriate authority for roadsteads, harbours, rivers, lakes, or inland waterways connected with the high seas and navigable by seagoing vessels. Such special rules shall conform as closely as possible to these Rules.

4. One local rule specific to inland waters of the US is that a vessel must sound one prolonged blast when getting underway. When un-berthing tomorrow, specifically at what point will you be underway? (R. 3i) (2)

The word underway means a vessel is not at anchor, or made fast to the shore, or aground. In this case when the last line is let-go.

After shareholders, you brief the CO on the departure. While examining the charts, he has several questions.

5. How should a vessel navigate down the course of a narrow channel or fairway? (R. 9a) (1)

A vessel proceeding along the course of a narrow channel or fairway shall keep as near to the outer limit or the channel or fairway which lies on her starboard side as is safe and practicable.

6. What vessels shall not impede the your passage of a vessel which can safety navigate only within a narrow channel or fairway? (R. 9b) (2)

Vessel of <20m or a sailing vessel.

7. There are several bends along the navigation track. What actions should you take when nearing a bend or an area of a narrow channel or fairway where other vessels may be obscured by an intervening obstruction? (R. 9f) (1)

A vessel nearing a bend or an area of narrow channel or fairway where other vessels may be obscured by an intervening obstruction shall navigate with particular alertness and caution and shall sound the appropriate signal prescribed in Rule 34e.

The CO approves the departure plan. You are up on the bridge early the next morning to make final preparations for sailing.

8. You sight a vessel in the early morning twilight proceeding outbound in the main channel showing white over red masthead lights in addition to sidelights and sternlight. What can you deduce about this vessel? (R. 29a) **(2)**

A vessel engaged in Pilotage duty, underway.

9. What additional identifying sound signal would this vessel make in restricted visibility? (R. 35k) **(2)**

A pilot vessel when engaged in pilotage duties may in addition to the signals prescribed...sound an identity signal consisting of four short blasts.

The ship closes up SSD and after sailing from alongside the CO hands you the ship and you commence the outbound pilotage.

10. On taking the ship you sight a small power-driven vessel at green 45 at 5 cables crossing the channel. Her bearing is steady and it soon become clear that she will impeded your passage and involve risk of collision. What is your obligation, who is the give-way vessel, and what is the obligation of the other vessel given she had already impeded your passage? (R. 8f, 9b, 15,) **(5)**

A vessel the passage of which is not to be impeded remains fully obliged to comply with the Rules of this part when two vessels are approaching so as to involve risk of collision (8f iii)(2). You are therefore still required to give way (1). A vessel required not to impede the passage or safe passage of another vessel is not relieved of this obligation if approaching the other vessel so as to involve risk of collision and shall, when taking action, have full regard to the action which may be required by the Rules of this part (8f ii)(2).

The above situation is resolved and the pilotage continues.

11. The OOW reports an outbound merchant vessel closing slowly from red 170 at 2nm. What situation is this? (R. 13b) **(2)**

Overtaking situation (1), the merchant vessel is coming up with your vessel from a direction more than 22.5° abaft your beam (1).

12. If you alter course 70° to port in accordance with your navigation track how would this change the situation? (R. 13d) **(2)**

It wouldn't change any obligation under Rule 13 (1), any subsequent alteration of bearing between the two vessels shall not make the overtaking vessel a crossing vessel within the meaning of these rules or relieve her of the duty of keeping clear of the overtaken vessel until she is finally past and clear (1).

13. Your CO keen to avoid being overtaken by a merchant vessel suggests an increase in speed to 20 knots. What do the rules state about every vessel proceeding at a safe speed and detail the factors which should be among those taken into account by all vessels? (R 6a, 6b) **(7)**

Every vessel shall at all times proceed at a safe speed so that she can take proper and effective action to avoid collision and be stopped within a distance appropriate to the prevailing circumstances and conditions (1).

6 of the following (1 mark each):

- (i) the state of visibility;
 - (ii) the traffic density including concentrations of fishing vessels or any other vessels;
 - (iii) the manoeuvrability of the vessel with special reference to stopping distance and turning ability in the prevailing conditions;
 - (v) the state of wind, sea and current, and the proximity of navigational hazards;
 - (vi) the draught in relation to the available depth of water.
- (i) the characteristics, efficiency and limitations of the radar equipment;

You clear Point Loma and fall out SSD. At red 20 at 5nm you sight two small power driven vessels. Their range is closing and with both vessels visual bearings drawing very slowly right.

14. As the range reduces to 3nm you sight two cones apexes together on both vessels. What do these shapes mean? (R. 26b) (1)

A vessel engaged in fishing/trawling.

15. How is this vessel defined? (R. 3d) (1)

The term "vessel engaged in fishing" means any vessel fishing with nets, lines, trawls or other fishing apparatus which restrict manoeuvrability, but does not include a vessel fishing with trolling lines or other fishing apparatus which do not restrict manoeuvrability.

16. What lights would these vessels show by night? (R. 26b) (3)

A vessel engaged in fishing, other than trawling, shall exhibit:

- (i) two all-round lights in a vertical line, the upper being red and the lower white, or a shape consisting of two cones with apexes together in a vertical line one above the other (1);**
- (ii) when there is outlying gear extending more than 150 metres horizontally from the vessel, an all-round white light or a cone apex upwards in the direction of the gear (1)**
- (iii) when making way through the water, in addition to the lights prescribed in this paragraph, sidelights and a sternlight (1).**

17. What sound signals would this vessel make in restricted visibility? (R. 35c) (2)

One prolonged followed by two short blasts at intervals of not more than 2 minutes.

18. In accordance with Rule 18 you make a bold alteration of course to starboard to keep clear of the fishing vessels. Should you use sound signals prior to this manoeuvre? Justify your answer. (R. 34a) (2)

Yes (1), when vessels are in sight of one another, a power-driven vessel underway, when manoeuvring as authorised or required by these Rules, shall indicate that manoeuvre by signals on her whistle (1).

You clear these vessels and proceed toward your ADEX RV. Unfortunately visibility begins to reduce to 1nm.

19. You detect by radar alone the presence of another vessel at red 20 range 5nm. What must you determine, and if action to avoid collision is required, what should be avoided? (4)

Shall determine if a close-quarters situation is developing and/or risk of collision exists (1). If so, she shall take avoiding action in ample time, provided that when such action consists of an alteration in course, so far as possible the following shall be avoided (1):

(i) An alteration of course to port for a vessel forward of the beam, other than for a vessel being overtaken (1);

(ii) An alteration of course toward a vessel abeam or abaft the beam (1).

20. You now hold a small power driven vessel visually at green 40 at 1nm and are 60° on her port bow with the bearing drawing very slowly left. Does Rule 19 apply to this situation, and explain how you would manoeuvre for this contact. (R. 19a, 15) (3)

Rule 19 applies to vessels not in sight of one another when navigating in or near an area of restricted visibility (1). Therefore, Rules in part B section II apply (1). This is therefore a crossing situation and you should manoeuvre in accordance with Rule 15. In this case, an alteration of course to starboard or a reduction in speed would be acceptable (1).

Visibility increases to excess of 5nm and you continue your transit to the RV.

21. You approach the formation and note that all other ships are in station. What is stated about how ships in and not in station should manoeuvre? (ATP1F) (2)

Ships that are not in station are not to hamper those in station (1). Ships in station should not stubbornly maintain their course and speed if danger of collision exists (1).

22. What is the order of priority applicable to Allied Naval ships? (ATP1F) (6)

Priority is in the following order:

(1) Helicopters.

(2) MCM Units.

(3) Ships Engaged in Replenishment.

(4) Ships Engaged in Launching or Recovery of Landing Craft Utilities.

(5) Ships Engaged in the Launching or Recovery of Aircraft.

(6) Ships Engaged in the Launching or Recovery of Arrays.

23. Do the priorities above take precedence over the International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea between military vessels at sea? (ATP1F) (1)

Yes, the priorities above are applicable to Allied naval ships and overrule the International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea in the circumstances described.

The exercise completes at sunset. As you break away you note that the USS Carrier does not have navigation lights in standard positions.

24. What do the Rules say about the operation of special rules with respect to additional station or signal lights? (R. 1c) (2)

Whenever the Government concerned shall have determined that a vessel of special construction or purpose (1) cannot comply fully with the provision of any of these rules with respect to the number, position, range or arc of visibility of lights or shapes, as well as to the disposition and characteristics of sound-signalling appliances, without interfering with the special function of the vessel, such vessel shall comply with such other provisions in regard to the number, position, range or arc of visibility of lights or shapes, as well as to the disposition and characteristics of sound-signalling appliances, as her Government shall have determined to be the closest possible compliance with these rules in respect to that vessel. (1)

You are preparing night orders after a long day on the bridge when the USS Carrier sends Flag 5 with a time and you hear her sounding 6 short blasts.

25. What does this mean? (ATP 1F) (1)

Machinery breakdown

You report this to the CO and head down below for dinner.

Total _____ / 58